

LG, Intel collaborate on future MIDs

LG Electronics and Intel have announced a collaboration for mobile Internet devices (MIDs). This is based on Intel's MID hardware platform, codenamed Moorestown, and Linux-based Moblin v2.0 software platform. The LG device is expected to be one of the first Moorestown designs to enter the market.

LG and Intel's common goal is to unleash rich Internet experiences across a range of mobile devices while delivering the functionality of today's high-end smart phones. The collaboration on the new design extends the close working relationship the two companies have enjoyed across their respective mobile product lines, which now spans the notebook, netbook and MID categories.

"The MID segment will drive growth at LG Electronics. We chose Intel's next-generation Moorestown platform and Moblin-based OS to pursue this segment because of the high performance and Internet compatibility this brings to our service provider customers," said Jung Jun Lee, executive vice president of LG Electronics and head of its Mobile Communications Business Division. "The collaboration with Intel on the MID platform has been valuable and further extends our longstanding relationship. Our efforts are well on track and we look forward to bringing the MID to market."

Red Hat, Microsoft in virtualisation inter-op pac

Red Hat and Microsoft customers will now be able to run Microsoft Windows Server and Red Hat Enterprise Linux virtual servers on either host environment, with configurations that will be tested and supported by both virtualisation and operating system companies. Red Hat, in response to strong customer demand, has signed reciprocal agreements with Microsoft to enable increased interoperability for the companies' virtualisation platforms.

Each company will join the other's virtualisation validation/certification programme and will provide coordinated technical support for their mutual server virtualisation customers. The reciprocal validations will allow customers to deploy heterogeneous, virtualised Red Hat and Microsoft solutions with confidence, said sources from the newly signed partnership. "The world of IT today is a mixture of virtualised and non-virtualised environments. Red Hat is looking to help our customers extend more rapidly into virtualised environments, including mixed Red Hat Enterprise Linux and Windows Server environments," said Mike Evans, vice president, corporate development, Red Hat.

The key components of the reciprocal agreements are Red Hat will validate Windows Server guests to be supported on Red Hat Enterprise virtualisation technologies; Microsoft will validate Red Hat Enterprise Linux server guests to be supported on Windows Server Hyper-V and Microsoft Hyper-V Server; and once each company completes testing, customers with valid support agreements will receive coordinated technical support to run the Windows Server OS virtualised on Red Hat Enterprise Linux, and to run Red Hat Enterprise Linux virtualised on Windows Server Hyper-V and Microsoft Hyper-V Server. The agreements establish coordinated technical support for Microsoft and Red Hat's mutual customers using server virtualisation, and the activities included in these agreements do not require the sharing of IP. Therefore, the agreements do not include any patent or open source licensing rights, and additionally contain no financial clauses, other than industry-standard certification/validation testing fees.



First open source standard for storage encryption solutions

Sun Microsystems has released the world's first generic communication protocol between a Key Manager and an encrypting device into the open source community. According to Sun, this latest effort in open source gives customers greater choice, value and flexibility through the resources in open source communities, like the growing storage community within OpenSolaris. The release enables partners to adopt the protocol to securely handle encryption keys without additional licensing. The protocol is implemented as a complete toolkit and is downloadable from the OpenSolaris website opensolaris.org/os/project/kmsagenttoolkit.

"Open Storage solutions allow customers to break free from the chains of proprietary hardware and software, and this new protocol extends this lifeline into the expensive and highly fragmented encryption market," said Jason Schaffer, senior director, storage product management, Sun Microsystems. "Open source equals customer value for encryption solutions, and Sun now offers the only solution on the market that works across multiple vendors and suppliers."

